Families Come Together Again After Leaving Oleshky

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People who left the city of Oleshky have crossed into land held by Ukraine, Ukrainian **officials** said. The trip was possible because of a short local **ceasefire**, a pause in the fighting.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said everyone will get the help they need. He thanked the U.S. and Melania Trump for helping to arrange the trip.

The people travelled by bus and plane through Russia and Belarus. About 2,000 people were still living in Oleshky. They could choose to travel to land held by Ukraine or by Russia, or to stay in the city with food and medicine, the article says.

On Saturday, families waited at the **border** to welcome them. **Aid** groups like the Red Cross were there too. Liza Paliy, 19, was waiting for her father. She last saw him more than two years ago.

Word Treasure

ceasefire -- A ceasefire is an agreement to pause fighting for a time.

officials -- Officials are people who hold important jobs in a government or organisation.

border -- A border is the line or area where one country or territory meets another.

Aid -- Aid is help given to people who need it, such as food, medicine or support.

Background you need

A ceasefire is a pause in fighting, and a short local one can let people travel more safely.

People who had left the city of Oleshky travelled by bus and plane through Russia and Belarus to reach land held by Ukraine.

Families and aid groups waited at the border to welcome them and help them when they arrived.

Break it down

WHO: People who left the city of Oleshky, their families, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, and aid groups like the Red Cross.

WHAT: The people crossed into land held by Ukraine, and families came together again at the border.

WHERE: From Oleshky, travelling through Russia and Belarus, to land held by Ukraine.

WHY: A short local ceasefire made the trip possible, and some families, like Liza Paliy and her father, had not seen each other for more than two years.

Why it matters

It shows children why being together with your family matters, especially after a very long time apart.

Test what you remember

1. What made the trip from Oleshky possible?

- (A) A bus and a plane
- (B) A short local ceasefire
- (C) Food and medicine
- (D) The Red Cross

2. Who said everyone will get the help they need?

- (A) Liza Paliy
- (B) Melania Trump
- (C) President Volodymyr Zelenskyy
- (D) Ukrainian officials only

3. How did the people travel?

- (A) Only by bus
- (B) Only by plane
- (C) By bus and plane through Russia and Belarus
- (D) On foot to the border

4. About how many people were still living in Oleshky?

- (A) More than two years' worth
- (B) 19
- (C) About 2,000
- (D) Two

5. What choices did the people still in Oleshky have?

- (A) Travel to land held by Ukraine or by Russia, or stay in the city with food and medicine
- (B) Stay or leave by boat only
- (C) Travel only to Russia
- (D) Wait at the border

6. Who was Liza Paliy, 19, waiting for?

- (A) Her neighbours
- (B) A Red Cross worker
- (C) President Zelenskyy
- (D) Her father

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: C 3: C 4: C 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy: He said everyone will get the help they need, and he thanked the U.S. and Melania Trump for helping to arrange the trip.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):